

# Kore.ai — Deepgram Account Brief

Generated 2026-10-05 · Depth: quick · Fit score: **66/100 (active prospect)** · Legend: [n] = sourced fact · **HYPOTHESIS** = hypothesis, verify · **Unknown** = not found

## TL;DR

- Who:** Kore.ai, Inc. is a private conversational and agentic AI platform. It is a Gartner MQ Leader for the fourth time [11] and claims 500+ large enterprises and 20B+ interactions per year (vendor claim) [19]. It is already a **Deepgram partner**: Nova-3 and Aura-2 are native speech providers in its platform [1].
- Why now:** The Artemis edition of the Kore.ai Agent Platform (May 2026) is built natively on Azure, including **Azure Speech Services** [6][8]. A new Chief Commercial Officer (July 2026) [10] and fresh AllianceBernstein capital (Jan 2026) [3] add urgency.
- Pain:** **HYPOTHESIS** Deepgram is one of several selectable speech engines [13]. As Artemis standardizes on Azure, Azure Speech becomes the path of least resistance, and Deepgram's share of Kore.ai voice traffic is at risk.
- Motion:** **OEM / embed plus partner co-sell.** Make Deepgram the *default* STT/TTS (and real-time voice layer) in Artemis, then co-sell into Kore.ai's banking and healthcare voice deals.
- Win:** Prasanna Arikala (CTO and Head of Products) on the architecture, and Uma Sandilya (CCO) on joint go-to-market [10][18].
- Ask:** "In Artemis, which speech engine is the default for a new voice agent, and what would it take for that to be Deepgram?"

## 1. Account Snapshot

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Company          | Kore.ai, Inc.: enterprise conversational/agentic AI software. HQ Orlando, Bay Area strategic HQ since May 2026. Private [5]                                                                     |
| Scale            | ARR above \$100M as of Jan 2024 <b>STALE</b> [19]; 500+ enterprises and 20B+ interactions/yr (vendor claim) [19]; ~\$296M total disclosed funding [17]                                          |
| Strategy         | Artemis is "AI-native" and built to "build, govern, and optimize" enterprise agents. It supports 40+ voice/digital channels and 300+ integrations, launching first on Azure (2026-05-21) [6][8] |
| Financial signal | AllianceBernstein-led growth investment (undisclosed size) to "expand commercial activity" (2026-01-27) [3]; \$150M led by FTV Capital with NVIDIA <b>STALE</b> (2024) [4]                      |
| Relationship     | Existing Deepgram partner [1]. Deepgram's CMO spoke at Kore.ai re:imagine 2025 <b>STALE</b> [2]. No sales threads found in the seller's email/calendar                                          |

## 2. Why Now

| When       | Trigger                                                                                                                          | So what for Deepgram                                                                                              |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026-08    | Named Leader in five Gartner, Forrester, and Everest evaluations [12]                                                            | More enterprise voice RFPs flow through Kore.ai, so the default speech engine matters more                        |
| 2026-07    | Uma Sandilya becomes CCO over sales, marketing, and strategy; Rajavardhan Nalluri becomes Chief Customer Operations Officer [10] | New leaders are setting partner and GTM priorities. A co-sell plan pitched now lands in their first-year planning |
| 2026-05-21 | Artemis launches, Azure-first, using Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, and <b>Azure Speech Services</b> [6][8]                     | <b>Displacement risk</b> for Deepgram's native slot. Also an opening to offer real-time voice they don't yet have |
| 2026-05-05 | Bay Area strategic HQ; new CGO, CSO, and CMO hired [5]                                                                           | New marketing and strategy leaders mean a chance for joint launches and content                                   |
| 2026-01-27 | AllianceBernstein growth investment [3]                                                                                          | Budget for commercial expansion, including co-sell programs                                                       |

### 3. Platform & Stack

| Layer                     | Vendor (evidence)                                                                                | Class → implication                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Speech engine (STT/TTS)   | Deepgram Nova-3 and Aura-2 native [1]; Google STT, Amazon Polly, ElevenLabs also selectable [13] | Deepgram is the <b>incumbent partner</b> but not the exclusive engine. Google, Polly, and ElevenLabs are competitors |
| Cloud / AI infrastructure | Artemis built on Azure, including Azure Speech Services [8]                                      | <b>Competitor (Azure Speech)</b> , the biggest threat to Deepgram's share                                            |
| Telephony / CCaaS         | Own Voice Gateway; integrates with Genesys (AppFoundry), Twilio, AudioCodes [13][14]             | <b>Partners.</b> Opens three-way plays (Genesys or Twilio + Kore.ai + Deepgram)                                      |
| LLM                       | Azure OpenAI / Foundry [8]                                                                       | Not speech. The Voice Agent API's bring-your-own-LLM design fits                                                     |
| Ecosystem                 | Microsoft Agent 365 launch partner; Dynamics 365 joint GTM [9]                                   | <b>HYPOTHESIS</b> Microsoft co-sell may pull voice deals toward Azure Speech                                         |

**Ops & hiring:** 19 open roles (Aug 2026), including Conversational AI Development Architects building IVR and voice assistants. Offices in Orlando, San Mateo, New York, Irving, and Hyderabad [17]. No dedicated ASR/TTS engineering roles found, which suggests **HYPOTHESIS** speech is bought, not built.

### 4. Buying Committee

| Person                                                 | Background                                                                    | Likely role                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Prasanna Arikala, CTO & Head of Products               | Leads product development and strategy [18]                                   | <b>Technical and economic buyer</b> for the default speech engine |
| Uma Sandilya, Chief Commercial Officer                 | Joined as CGO in May 2026, CCO since July 2026; ex-C3.ai, ex-McKinsey [5][10] | <b>GTM sponsor</b> for co-sell and joint pipeline                 |
| Raj Koneru, Founder & CEO                              | Founder, still CEO [3]                                                        | Executive sponsor for a strategic speech partnership              |
| Rajavardhan Nalluri, Chief Customer Operations Officer | Appointed July 2026 [10]                                                      | Owns delivery. Feels voice accuracy escalations first             |
| Unknown: Head of Voice / Alliances lead                | Not found                                                                     | Find in discovery. Likely the day-to-day <b>champion</b>          |

### 5. Pain → Deepgram Fit

| Signal                                                                  | <b>HYPOTHESIS</b> Pain                                                      | Deepgram answer + proof                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Artemis is Azure-native, including Azure Speech [8]                     | Pressure to default to Azure Speech for simplicity                          | Deepgram deploys in their VPC or self-hosted, so it stays inside the Azure tenancy. Offer a bake-off on Kore.ai customer audio |
| Voice wins in banking (90% call containment) and health payers [15][16] | Authentication and alphanumeric failures cap containment in regulated voice | Five9 healthcare deployment: 2x authentication rate, 2–4x better alphanumeric accuracy                                         |
| Speech engine chosen per deployment from several options [13]           | Inconsistent quality, many vendors to support, margin leakage               | One stack for STT, TTS, and voice agent at lower cost than hyperscalers                                                        |
| Agentic, multi-agent platform push [6][7]                               | Voice agents need natural turn-taking, not press-1 IVR                      | Voice Agent API: real-time STT + bring-your-own LLM + TTS with barge-in                                                        |

| Signal                                       | <i>HYPOTHESIS</i> Pain     | Deepgram answer + proof                                   |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Regulated buyers (banks, payers)<br>[15][16] | On-prem / VPC requirements | On-prem reference in banking (Elerian AI, >90% precision) |

**ROI sketch (per joint end customer):** a payer with 5M calls/yr (assumed) × 40% automatable (assumed) × 60% containment (assumed) × (\$6 – \$1) per call (assumed) ≈ **\$6M/yr**; conservative (30% × 50% × \$4) ≈ **\$3M/yr**. For Kore.ai itself, the lever is speech COGS and containment uplift across its voice base. Inputs: Unknown, ask.

## 6. Talk Track & Objections

- **Opener:** "Artemis is Azure-first, and that's fine: Deepgram runs inside your Azure tenancy. Let's make sure the speech layer under your voice agents is the one that wins your banking and payer bake-offs."
- **Angles:** *CTO:* default engine, latency, barge-in, VPC deployment, Voice Agent API for real-time agents. *CCO:* joint pipeline in healthcare and banking; Deepgram brings the speech proof points. *Customer Ops:* fewer accuracy escalations on IDs, names, and accents.
- **Proof:** Five9 healthcare (2x authentication); Elerian AI (on-prem banking, >90% precision).

| Objection                         | Response                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "We're Azure-native now"          | Deepgram can run in your VPC, so audio never leaves Azure. Compare accuracy, latency, and cost per hour on your customers' audio |
| "Customers pick their own engine" | Defaults drive most choices. Make the best-tested engine the default and keep the choice                                         |
| "Speech is a commodity"           | Alphanumerics and accents decide containment. Five9 saw 2x authentication                                                        |
| "Margin / pricing"                | Lower cost at scale than hyperscaler speech; structure an OEM rate on volume                                                     |

## 7. Discovery Questions

1. What share of Kore.ai voice minutes run on Deepgram vs. Azure Speech, Google, and others today, and what is the default in Artemis?
2. Is Azure Speech being bundled into Artemis by default or through the Microsoft co-sell? What would make Deepgram the default?
3. Where do voice deployments fail today (authentication/alphanumerics, accents, latency, barge-in), and in which accounts?
4. How do customers buy speech today: bundled in Kore.ai pricing, or bring-your-own Deepgram key?
5. Who owns the voice roadmap and speech-provider partnerships day to day, and is real-time speech-to-speech on the Artemis roadmap?

## 8. Next Best Actions

1. **Internal / Deepgram partner team:** Pull Kore.ai attach data (tenants, minutes, trend since Artemis launched) before any outreach.
2. **Prasanna Arikala / email via partner manager:** Propose an Artemis voice roadmap session covering default-engine status, a bake-off vs. Azure Speech on consented customer audio, and Voice Agent API fit.
3. **Uma Sandilya / LinkedIn or warm intro:** Propose a joint healthcare-payer and banking co-sell play using the Five9 and Elerian proof points.
4. **Marketing / re:imagine 2027:** Pitch a joint session or customer case study, following on from Deepgram's re:imagine 2025 talk [2].

**Fit score:** Volume 24/30 · Pain 12/25 · Timing 17/20 · Stack 15/15 · Access 8/10 · Competitor adj –10 (Azure Speech in Artemis, 2026) = **66/100**

## Sources

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